

FORGE Phase 1 • Week 12 • Session 35 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 35: Portfolio Review" in the Phase 1 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: forgementors.org/media.html

Session 35 as written runs the full 120 minutes, so the run of show adds no talk (an optional one is listed below). The one short video takes about two minutes of the Opening, in place of the "Here's how today works" explanation.

What's in this insert

- **Video 35, "Portfolio Review"** (2 min 10 s). The knowledge check is one piece; today is the real evidence of growth. It shows how a presentation works (about 8 minutes: contents, highlights, self-assessment), says to speak from the essay rather than read it, and says the panel's questions are "not an interrogation. It's a conversation about your growth," with one sample question from the guide. It asks the men to listen with respect while others present, shows the eight portfolio items in two columns, and ends on the completeness check, "Open your portfolio. Is every piece there?", held for 20 seconds.
- No talk in the run of show: the session already runs two hours, and the presentations need all 80 minutes. An optional talk is listed below if presentations finish early.

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	Opening: Knowledge Check results, then Video 35	10	Share scores first, as written (Option A or B; never announce a failing score). Then play the video. It covers "Here's how today works," so you only need to name the panel members.
0:10	Portfolio completeness check	10	Starts on the question the video ends on. Go around the room with the checklist, as written.
0:20	Portfolio presentations	80	As written: about 8 minutes each, rubric in hand.
1:40	Individual feedback	10	As written.
1:50	Closing	10	As written: one-word round.

If presentations run long, and with 12 to 15 men they may, the guide lets you finish them in Session 36. The Session 36 insert has room for that (see its notes).

Optional talk (if time allows)

Not part of the run of show. Use it for a make-up session, when presentations finish early, or to prepare yourself before the panel.

- **Emily Esfahani Smith**, *There's more to life than being happy* (TED2017, 12 minutes 8 seconds). Four pillars of a meaningful life; the fourth is storytelling, "the story you tell yourself about yourself," which is what a portfolio presentation is.

Discussion questions:

1. She says: "You can edit, interpret and retell your story, even as you're constrained by the facts." In your self-assessment, which facts stayed the same, and what changed about how you tell them?
2. Emeka's first story was "My life was great playing football, but now look at me." His new one was "my injury made me realize I could be a better man," and he started mentoring kids. What is the difference between retelling your story honestly and just making it sound good? How would a panel tell the difference?
3. The psychologist she quotes found that people leading meaningful lives tell stories "defined by redemption, growth and love." Which moment from Phase 1 belongs in your story?

Preview: calm and clean; she mentions the rising suicide rate once and calls gangs "cultures of meaning."

- **YouTube** (TED's official channel): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=y9Trdafp83U>
- Also on TED.com: https://www.ted.com/talks/emily_esfahani_smith_there_s_more_to_life_than_being_happy

TED talks carry a Creative Commons BY-NC-ND license. TED's usage policy says a single talk used in one lesson is generally permitted, with credit to TED. It also says a talk used as a standing part of a curriculum across many sessions or cohorts "may require a separate license," and that talks should not be scraped from TED's site. The prison has no internet, so write to TED (help.ted.com, licensing) for an offline copy for a nonprofit, no-fee, in-prison program, and clear it under the facility's media rules before showing it.

Checklist additions

- ☐ Video 35 loaded on the playback device and tested with sound
- ☐ Scores ready to share before the video plays